Diamond Ali Pacasum Pangarungan

Princess Diamond Ali Pacasum Pangarungan is a Maranao civic leader, former legislator, and cultural heritage advocate from Lanao del Sur. She spent the better part of three decades moving between public office and community work, first as an Assemblywoman in the Regional Legislative Assembly of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao, and later as a fixture in nearly every major civic organization Marawi City had to offer. Her name carries weight not just because of the offices she held, but because of the institutions she helped build from scratch, among them the Lanao People's Park and Public Library and the Lanao Cultural Heritage Foundation, both of which still serve her home province today. She is married to Atty. Saidamen Balt Pangarungan, who would go on to serve as Secretary of the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos and later as Chairman of the Commission on Elections.

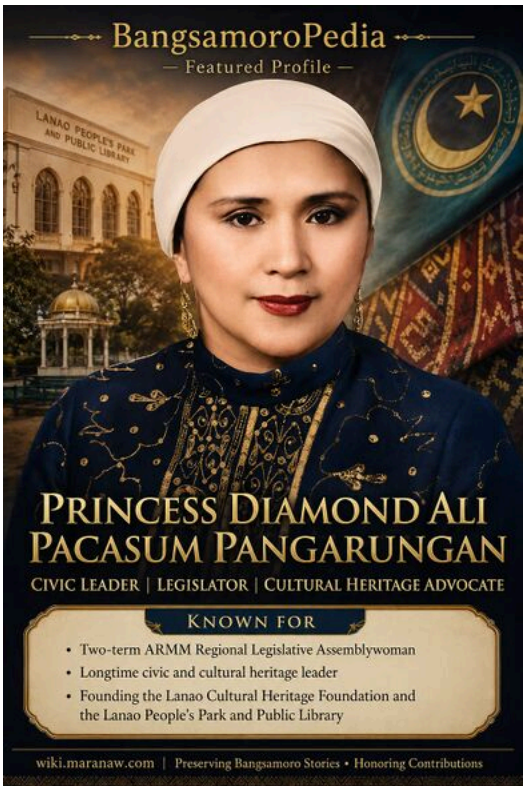
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BACKGROUND

Princess Diamond Ali Pacasum Pangarungan was born to Sheik Abdul Rahman Pacasum and Bai a Labi Pala Ali of Baloi, Lanao del Norte. Her family ties run deep into Maranao tradition, and that grounding would later shape much of the cultural preservation work she became known for. She is the spouse of Atty. Saidamen Balt Pangarungan, former Secretary of the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos and former Chairman of the Commission on Elections, and together they have three children: Nikkolai, Saidamer, and Ramayana Saidamen.

Princess Diamond Ali Pacasum Pangarungan



Spouse

Atty. Saidamen Balt Pangarungan (Former NCMF Secretary, Former COMELEC Chairman)

Children

Nikkolai D. Saidamen, Saidamer D. Saidamen, Ramayana D. Saidamen

Parents

Sheik Abdul Rahman Pacasum and Bai a Labi Pala Ali of Baloi, Lanao del Norte

Political Service

Assemblywoman, 1st District of Lanao del Sur, Regional Legislative Assembly, ARMM (1990 to 1997)

Education

Philippine Women's University (College); University of Asia and the Pacific (Post Graduate)

Notability

Two-term ARMM Regional Legislative Assemblywoman and longtime civic and

cultural heritage leader from Lanao del Sur

Known For

Founding the Lanao Cultural Heritage Foundation and the Lanao People's Park and Public Library

EDUCATION

She began her schooling at Raya Madaya Elementary School in Marawi City before moving on to Jamiatul Philippines Al-Islamia for her secondary education, also in Marawi City. She pursued her college degree at the Philippine Women's University along Taft Avenue in Manila, and later took her post graduate studies at the University of Asia and the Pacific in Ortigas Center, Pasig City, where she completed a one year study grant in Strategic Business and Economic Planning from 1996 to 1997.

CAREER

Pangarungan's career began in the halls of national government before it shifted toward regional politics and civic work back home. From 1973 to 1975, she served as Executive Assistant at the Batasan Pambansa, which later became the House of Representatives, in Batasan Hills, Quezon City. From there she moved to the Philippine Amanah Bank in Manila, where she worked as Budget Officer from 1974 to 1976.

Her entry into elected office came in 1990, when she was elected Assemblywoman for the 1st District of Lanao del Sur in the Regional Legislative Assembly of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao, based in Cotabato City. She served that term until 1994, and was re-elected for a second term that ran from 1992 to 1997. During her years in the assembly, she also took on national-level roles, serving as Commissioner of the National Commission on the Role of Filipino Women from 1998 to 2000, where she represented Indigenous Cultural Communities for the Autonomous Region in Mindanao, and as a Board of Governor for the Philippine National Red Cross National Headquarters during that same period.

LEGISLATIVE WORK

As a legislator, Pangarungan authored the bill creating the Bureau of Cultural Heritage for the ARMM, a measure that reflected her long standing interest in preserving Maranao and broader Bangsamoro culture through formal institutions. She also filed several resolutions pushing for pilot projects in her home province, including the establishment of a food terminal for Lanao del Sur, a drug rehabilitation center in Marawi City, intensified irrigation canals for the province's low lying farming areas, and an integrated farming program spanning both Lanao del Sur and Lanao del Norte.

INSTITUTIONAL CONTRIBUTIONS

Beyond her legislative work, Pangarungan built a long record of hands on civic projects in Lanao del Sur. She established the first Provincial Skills and Livelihood Training Center at People's Park in Marawi City in 1993, and between 1991 and 1996 oversaw the establishment of all 18 municipal plazas across the 1st District of Lanao del Sur. From 1992 to 1994, she promoted a comprehensive livelihood training program aimed at barangay women and out of school youth, and she also donated books to municipal libraries and public schools throughout the province.

In 1992, she played a catalyst role in establishing the Lanao People's Park and Public Library in Marawi City, an institution she would go on to chair from 1990 to the present. That same civic instinct carried into her cultural heritage work: in 2000, she founded the Lanao Cultural Heritage Foundation, Inc., serving as its Chairman and President from then onward.

MEMBERSHIP AFFILIATIONS

Pangarungan's reach across civic and women's organizations in Lanao del Sur is extensive. She served as Regional Governor of the National Council of Women in the Philippines for the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao from 1998 to 1999, and as President of the Girl Scouts of the Philippines, Marawi City and Lanao del Sur Chapter, from 1995 to 1997. She has led the Philippine Women's University Alumni Association's Lanao del Sur and Marawi City Chapter as President since 1994, and earlier served as Director of Kiwanis International's Valle Verde Chapter in Pasig City from 1994 to 1995.

Her organizational leadership also extended to education and interfaith civic life. She was President of the League of Filipino Muslim Educators from 1993 to 1999, and President of the Rotary Marawi City Chapter from 1991 to 1995. She chaired the Philippine National Red Cross's Marawi City and Lanao del Sur Chapter from 1990 to 1994, served as President of the Lanao del Sur Mayor's Wives Association from 1990 to 1995, and was Director of the Fatima Sorority's Marawi City and Lanao del Sur Chapter, also from 1990 to 1994.

TRAININGS AND STUDY GRANTS

Pangarungan's record includes a wide range of in-service trainings and seminars tied to her work in governance, health, and regional planning. Through the Philippine National Red Cross, she attended the 2nd Strategic Planning Workshop Seminar for Board of Governors in October 1998, a Regional Training Program for Community Health and Nursing Service in February 1999, an Orientation Session for Board Members in February 2000, and a Strategic Planning Workshop and Session on Governance and Management in June 2000.

Her legislative training included the Parliamentary Procedures, Resolutions, Bills and Laws Drafting Workshop Seminar held at the Congressional Training and Research Center in Batasan Hills, Quezon City, in October 1994, as well as a Strategic Planning and Workshop session organized by the ARMM's Regional Planning and Development Office in November 1996. On the international stage, she took part in the EACAD High Level Inter-Governmental Meeting to Review Regional Implementation of the Beijing Platform for Action in Bangkok, Thailand, in October 1999, the ASEAN Export Workshop on Operationalizing the Work Program Activities II in Bandar Seri Begawan, Brunei Darussalam, in October 2000, and the APEC Summit on the Role of Women in Countrywide Development held at Malacanang in Manila in July 2000. She also completed her one year study grant in Strategic Business and Economic Planning at the University of Asia and the Pacific from 1996 to 1997.

RECOGNITION

Pangarungan's decades of public and civic service earned her recognition at multiple levels. The Philippine Women's University named her a CAPA Awardee and Most Outstanding Alumni for the entire Philippines in 1995 to 1996. The Marawi City and Lanao del Sur Sultanate League honored her as Most Outstanding Muslim Women Leader in 1992, 1993, and 1995, and the Mayor's League Association of Lanao del Sur Province gave her an Achievement Awardee distinction in 1992. She was also recognized in 1992 as a catalyst in the establishment of the Lanao People's Park and Public Library, a project she had championed from the ground up.

LEGACY

Pangarungan's legacy sits at the intersection of governance and grassroots civic building. Where many legislators are remembered mainly for the bills they passed, she is remembered just as much for the institutions she physically built and kept running long after her term ended, the municipal plazas, the skills training center, the public library,

and the cultural heritage foundation that continues to carry her name in Marawi City and Lanao del Sur today. Her work also helped spearhead Senator Santanina Rasul's "Tayo Ay Magbasa" literacy project across Lanao del Sur and Marawi City in 1994, extending her reach into the province's broader push for education and literacy.

SEE ALSO

- Lanao del Sur
- Marawi City
- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Saidamen Balt Pangarungan
- Maranao people

REFERENCES

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CATEGORIES

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